



Children at Shreyas Foundation, Ahmedabad, learn with My sCool Server

Getting our product to the market is another big challenge — we are working very hard at it.

Q. Does your company also provide maintenance services post installation?

A. Yes, My sCool Server comes with a one-year limited warranty and a three-year hardware warranty, which is provided by the hardware vendor. Extending the warranty period is also possible. Our engineers can remotely fix any issues when a connection is initiated from the device. Telephonic support is also provided when no Internet is available. We, of course, provide training to teachers who will be operating the device and also offer an excellent user manual, which includes a troubleshooting guide for any problems that may arise.

Apart from this, we understand that accidents happen and that everyone deserves a second chance. Being open source, one may be tempted to play around with the server but we do not penalise users for doing so. The My sCool Server provides factory restore options via the server boot menu or with a USB created with the *recovery.sh* tool.

The factory restore option restores the system to the state the server was in when it left Recherche Tech's premises, which may include customisation such as user accounts, etc, if that data had been given at the time of order placement.

“The open source ecosystem is immense, with a huge potential to innovate by building on the already available amazing technologies”

Schools can easily create as many custom snapshots as they want even after customisation to the system, which can be restored at any point. This frees them from depending on us.

Q. What is your sales strategy? Which is your preferred choice – the online or offline channel?

A. We are setting up offline channel partners and working with many corporates on their CSR projects. We are also trying to make inroads with different governments (for example, the Bhutan government) to roll out My sCool Server on a large scale.

The nature of our business is more suited to the offline sales model, which is our preferred choice, because schools usually prefer someone to come to their premises to demonstrate, deploy and provide training to teachers. However, being a

plug-and-play device that is intuitive to use, the online sales model could work as well.

Q. What challenges or uncertainties do you expect to face in the future?

A. Even though we have addressed the challenges of bringing together multiple complex technologies which are necessary in 21st century classrooms, conveying the real value of the developed product to the end users and getting every school to adopt it even in a small region is a massive challenge. My dream is to deliver the benefits of open source technologies and educational resources to every school possible.

Mass producing the device, distribution and customer support will be the other big challenges, once our user base crosses a critical mass.

Technology is ever evolving at a very fast pace, so keeping the device relevant with new developments as well as flexible in terms of providing new and user requested features quickly is another area to consider.

Q. You have built your business around open source. What would you suggest to other entrepreneurs who are doing the same, or those who would want to do so?

A. The open source ecosystem is immense, with a huge potential to innovate by building on the already available amazing technologies. Entrepreneurs must find their niche and build something that solves real problems. Also, the focus should not be to just make life easier for those using their product, but to also make it an enriching experience. It is very hard work, but if they make a positive impact, then it is all worth it. **END** 🐧

To know more about My sCool Server, refer to: <https://www.myscoolserver.com/>